Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd

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LEARNER GUIDE

For

Master Mobile Photography: Capturing Professional Photos with Your Smartphone

TGS Ref No: TGS-2022015227

Conducted by

Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd

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How to Use This Guide

Use the slides for concepts and visual discussion. Use this guide for the detailed procedures. Every activity also has a self-contained folder with a printable checklist, cheat sheet, evidence log and sample photo.

- Bring a smartphone with a functioning camera and enough free storage.
- Control names vary by phone model; use the equivalent Camera or Pro/Manual control.
- Never continue a capture when people, traffic, weather or equipment make it unsafe.
- Work non-destructively: keep original files before editing.

Course and Competency Overview

Item	Details
Course	Master Mobile Photography: Capturing Professional Photos with Your Smartphone
Course code	TGS-2022015227
TSC	Camera Operations · MED-MPN-3034-1.1
Duration	2 days · 16 hours
Assessment	WA: 8 open-ended questions, 90 min · PP: 3 tasks, 90 min

Learning Outcomes

- LO1: Set up a mobile phone camera for shooting and interpret a shot plan.
- LO2: Perform basic mobile photography while meeting safety requirements.
- LO3: Apply framing and composition techniques using a mobile phone camera.
- LO4: Enhance visual quality and effects using capture and editing controls.

Safety and Ethical Baseline

- Stop walking before raising the phone; never step backward without checking.
- Keep tripods, cables and team members out of exits and public movement paths.
- Ask consent for identifiable people and protect confidential screens, documents and badges.
- Use load-rated clamps/mounts; inspect locks and add a tether where equipment can fall.
- Respect location rules, weather limits and the instructions of the person in charge.

Topic 01: Setting Up a Mobile Camera for Shooting

Criteria: K1 · K2 · A1 · A2 · A3

Camera systems · accessories · inspection · shot planning · team coordination

From Film to Computational Cameras

- 35 mm film records light chemically
- Digital cameras record light on a sensor
- Smartphones combine optics, sensor and algorithms
- The useful question is fitness for purpose—not status

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Inside a Smartphone Camera

- Lens gathers and directs light

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- Sensor converts light into electrical data
- Image processor reduces noise and builds colour
- Computational capture may merge several frames

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Camera Types and Choosing Well

- Film: tactile process and finite frames
- Dedicated digital: larger controls and system lenses
- Mobile: always available, connected and discreet
- Choose by purpose, budget, speed and acceptable quality

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

The Multi-Camera Phone

- Ultra-wide expands the field of view
- Wide/main camera is usually the strongest all-rounder
- Telephoto changes framing without walking closer
- Macro/depth/periscope modules vary by device

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Fixed Aperture, Variable Decisions

- Most phone lenses use a fixed physical aperture
- Shutter time and ISO remain key exposure controls
- Portrait blur is often computed from depth data
- Do not promise an aperture control a phone does not have

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

File Formats and Resolution

- JPEG/HEIF are processed and compact
- RAW preserves more adjustment latitude
- Higher resolution gives crop room but uses storage
- Select format and aspect ratio for the final channel

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Why Mobile Photography Works

- The camera is already with you
- Capture, edit and share on one device
- Small size supports candid and low-profile work
- Accessories cost less than a full camera system

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Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Limits to Plan Around

- Small sensors struggle when light is scarce
- Digital zoom removes pixels
- Tiny lenses exaggerate flare and smudges
- Automation can misread focus, colour or depth

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Stability Accessories

- Two-handed grip reduces shake
- Tripod supports low light, panorama and repeatable framing
- Bluetooth or timer release avoids touch vibration
- A clamp must fit the phone and tighten securely

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Optical and Lighting Accessories

- Clip-on lenses must align with the correct module
- Filters can control glare or incoming light
- LED panels provide continuous, directional light
- A power bank protects a long assignment

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Accessory Selection Matrix

- Need: solve a real capture problem
- Fit: verify model, clamp and load compatibility
- Quality: check sharpness, flare and build
- Safety: inspect edges, joints, heat and cables

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

The Pre-Shoot Inspection

- Clean all active lenses with a microfibre cloth
- Check battery, storage and chosen format
- Test tripod locks, clamp, remote and light
- Record defects and remove unsafe equipment

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Safe Camera Handling

- Keep fingers clear of lenses

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- Stand balanced and stop before composing
- Use a wrist strap where a drop could injure
- Never step backward into traffic or hazards

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Anatomy of a Shot Plan

- Objective and audience
- Subject, location and production style
- Shot list with size, angle and composition
- Light, settings, equipment, safety and permissions

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Translate a Brief into Pictures

- Identify the message the client needs
- Select a visual style that supports it
- Turn deliverables into observable shot requirements
- Define acceptance criteria before capture

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Coordinate a Mounted Shot

- Agree roles and a clear call sequence
- Mark the tripod footprint away from public flow
- Confirm horizon, sweep direction and start/end points
- Stop when people enter the operating zone

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Privacy, Property and Consent

- Ask permission for identifiable people
- Avoid confidential screens, documents and badges
- Respect property rules and restricted locations
- Do not publish logos or faces without authority

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Activity 1: Plan and Inspect a Café Product Shoot

Goal

A neighbourhood café needs eight smartphone photographs of a signature dish and wellness product for a launch post.

Deliverable

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Approved shot plan, equipment inspection, safety check and two test frames

Tools

Smartphone, microfibre cloth, tabletop tripod, LED panel, reflector, power bank

Detailed Step-by-Step

1. Read the client brief and underline audience, message, channel and due time.
2. Write a shot objective and define the production style in three adjectives.
3. Create an eight-frame shot list covering wide, medium, close and detail views.
4. Assign composition, angle, orientation and light direction to each frame.
5. Check location rules, food handling boundaries, permissions and trip hazards.
6. Clean the active lens; verify battery, storage, file format and resolution.
7. Inspect the clamp, tripod locks, LED power and cable placement; record defects.
8. Place equipment without blocking staff or customers and take two test frames.
9. Review sharpness, reflections, highlights, colour and distracting background items.
10. Obtain peer/client approval of the shot plan before full capture.

Verification

- All eight shots map to a clear purpose
- Inspection checklist is complete
- No unsafe equipment remains in use
- Test frames meet focus and highlight criteria

Troubleshooting

- If the control is missing, use the closest native mode and document the limitation.
- If the image is soft, clean the lens, stabilise the phone, re-focus and capture again.
- If highlights clip, reduce exposure or change the light/camera position.
- If safety or consent cannot be established, stop and substitute a controlled subject or location.

Activity folder: activities/activity-01-*/

Activity 2: Coordinate a Safe Retail Panorama

Goal

A retail centre needs a clean panorama and supporting wide photographs showing an atrium without obstructing public movement.

Deliverable

Role call sheet, safe tripod setup, panorama and two supporting wide shots

Tools

Smartphone, tripod and clamp, Bluetooth remote, floor markers

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Detailed Step-by-Step

1. Walk the location and select a viewpoint with strong lines and a safe operating zone.
2. Confirm photography permission and identify faces, logos or screens to exclude.
3. Assign director, camera operator, safety observer and public liaison roles.
4. Agree the start cue, sweep direction, stop cue and interruption procedure.
5. Extend tripod legs fully on firm ground and test the clamp before mounting.
6. Set the phone at eye level, clean the lens and align a level horizon.
7. Mark a compact safety footprint without blocking exits or desire paths.
8. Run a rehearsal sweep; stop if any person enters the operating zone.
9. Capture the panorama slowly, then capture two wide stills using leading lines.
10. Inspect seams, bent geometry, moving-subject fragments and overall exposure.

Verification

- Roles and stop signals are documented
- Tripod is stable and non-obstructive
- Panorama has a level horizon and clean seams
- Supporting shots meet the aesthetic brief

Troubleshooting

- If the control is missing, use the closest native mode and document the limitation.
- If the image is soft, clean the lens, stabilise the phone, re-focus and capture again.
- If highlights clip, reduce exposure or change the light/camera position.
- If safety or consent cannot be established, stop and substitute a controlled subject or location.

Activity folder: activities/activity-02-*/

Topic 02: Basic Mobile Photography Skills

Criteria: K3 · K8 · A3 · A4 · A6

Exposure · focus · colour · light · lenses · low-light and motion control

Exposure Is a Creative Choice

- Protect important highlight detail
- Keep the subject bright enough to read
- Accept or suppress shadow detail deliberately
- Use brightness to support mood

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

The Exposure Triangle—Adapted for Phones

- Shutter time controls motion and incoming light

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- ISO amplifies the sensor signal and noise
- Aperture is normally fixed on the phone module
- Automation and multi-frame processing share the workload

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Shutter Time and Motion

- Fast capture freezes action
- Slow capture records motion as blur
- Panning follows a moving subject
- Long exposure needs stability and a controlled scene

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

ISO and Image Quality

- Low ISO generally gives cleaner detail
- Higher ISO helps in low light but adds noise
- Stabilise before raising ISO unnecessarily
- Judge the result at useful viewing size

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Tap Focus and Focus Lock

- Place focus on the intended subject
- Check eyes for portraits and detail for products
- Lock focus when recomposing or waiting for action
- Re-focus if subject distance changes

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Exposure Compensation and AE Lock

- Tap the subject or priority tone
- Move the brightness control up or down
- Lock exposure for a consistent sequence
- Review highlights and re-adjust before capture

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

White Balance and Colour Temperature

- Warm light shifts toward amber
- Cool light shifts toward blue
- Auto white balance may change between frames
- Set a preset or manual value for consistency

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Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

HDR and Dynamic Range

- High-contrast scenes exceed one exposure
- HDR blends frames for shadow and highlight detail
- Movement can cause ghosting
- Keep the phone steady and inspect edges

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Optical vs Digital Zoom

- Optical steps use another physical camera
- Digital zoom crops and enlarges pixels
- Move closer when it is safe
- Crop later when composition allows

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Perspective and Compression

- Camera position controls perspective
- Close wide-angle views exaggerate near objects
- Farther tele views appear more compressed
- Choose position first, then lens

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Read the Direction of Light

- Front light reveals detail
- Side light models form and texture
- Backlight creates rim light or silhouette
- Top light can deepen eye and nose shadows

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Soft, Hard and Available Light

- Large close sources create softer transitions
- Small or distant sources make hard edges
- Window light is an efficient soft source
- Use reflectors or white surfaces before flash

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Golden Hour, Blue Hour and Midday

- Golden hour gives warm directional light

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- Blue hour balances sky and city lights
- Midday produces hard shadows and bright highlights
- Match the time of day to the intended mood

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Night and Low-Light Strategy

- Clean the lens
- Use night mode or a stable support
- Lower exposure to protect bright lamps
- Use available light and expect some texture/noise

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Burst, Panorama and Portrait Modes

- Burst improves timing for action
- Panorama stitches a controlled sweep
- Portrait mode estimates subject separation
- Review seams, edges and depth errors

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Flash: Use with Intent

- On-phone flash is small and near the lens
- It can flatten faces and create hard reflections
- Prefer window, ambient or off-axis LED light
- Use flash only when its look solves the brief

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

A Clean Capture Routine

- Clean · stabilise · frame
- Focus · set brightness · lock if needed
- Capture a short variation set
- Review sharpness, highlights and distractions

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Activity 3: Control Exposure and Colour at a Corporate Event

Goal

An event organiser needs speaker and audience photographs under mixed warm stage light and cool ambient light.

Deliverable

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Exposure/focus test set, white-balance comparison and five usable event frames

Tools

Smartphone with Pro/Manual mode or exposure compensation, optional monopod

Detailed Step-by-Step

1. Identify the priority subject and the brightest important highlight in the scene.
2. Clean the lens, silence flash and choose a stable, permitted camera position.
3. Tap the speaker's face to focus and lower exposure until facial highlights retain detail.
4. Lock AE/AF for a consistent burst when distance and light remain unchanged.
5. Capture a short burst at a gesture or interaction, then select the sharpest frame.
6. Compare auto, warm and cool white-balance settings on the same scene.
7. Choose the setting that keeps skin credible while preserving the intended atmosphere.
8. Capture a wide establishing view, two medium interactions and two close reactions.
9. Check motion blur, focus, colour shifts, clipped screens and distracting badges.
10. Record the chosen focus, exposure and white-balance decisions in the evidence log.

Verification

- Faces are sharp and readable
- Important highlights are not clipped
- White balance is consistent across the sequence
- Five frames cover place, action and reaction

Troubleshooting

- If the control is missing, use the closest native mode and document the limitation.
- If the image is soft, clean the lens, stabilise the phone, re-focus and capture again.
- If highlights clip, reduce exposure or change the light/camera position.
- If safety or consent cannot be established, stop and substitute a controlled subject or location.

Activity folder: activities/activity-03-*/

Activity 4: Freeze and Blur Motion at Blue Hour

Goal

A city mobility campaign needs one frozen-action frame and one creative motion frame from a safe waterfront location.

Deliverable

Frozen-action image, panning image, low-light comparison and settings log

Tools

Smartphone with burst/manual controls, tripod or stable support, Bluetooth remote

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Detailed Step-by-Step

1. Choose a safe pedestrian viewpoint away from the travel path of moving subjects.
2. Map the subject direction and select a background with visible lines or lights.
3. For freeze: use burst or a fast shutter option and pre-focus where action will occur.
4. Capture several passes and select the frame with sharp subject and strong gesture.
5. For panning: reduce shutter speed where supported and track before releasing.
6. Continue the movement smoothly after release and repeat several passes.
7. For static low light: stabilise the phone and use night mode or a slow capture.
8. Lower exposure if bright lamps lose colour or detail.
9. Compare sharpness, noise, blur direction and highlight retention at full view.
10. Log the variables that changed the result and explain which image fits the campaign.

Verification

- Capture position is safe
- Frozen frame has a readable subject
- Panning frame communicates motion
- Settings/effect relationship is explained

Troubleshooting

- If the control is missing, use the closest native mode and document the limitation.
- If the image is soft, clean the lens, stabilise the phone, re-focus and capture again.
- If highlights clip, reduce exposure or change the light/camera position.
- If safety or consent cannot be established, stop and substitute a controlled subject or location.

Activity folder: activities/activity-04-*/

Topic 03: Framing and Composition

Criteria: K4 · K5 · A5

Visual hierarchy · placement · lines · space · depth · patterns · emotive arrangement

Composition Directs Attention

- Choose one primary subject
- Remove elements that compete
- Use placement, scale and contrast to guide the eye
- The frame includes everything—wanted or not

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Rule of Thirds

- Divide the frame into a three-by-three grid

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- Place key subjects near intersections
- Align important horizons with a third
- Leave space toward a gaze or movement

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

When Centre Composition Works

- Symmetrical architecture
- Strong faces and direct gaze
- Graphic shapes and isolated subjects
- Use deliberate balance—not automatic centring

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Balance and Symmetry

- Symmetry can be vertical, horizontal or radial
- Visual weight includes brightness, colour and size
- Asymmetrical balance feels dynamic
- Minor imperfection can keep symmetry human

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Pattern, Proportion, Rhythm and Unity

- Pattern repeats form or colour
- Proportion compares visual sizes
- Rhythm controls the repeated path of the eye
- Unity makes separate elements feel intentional

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Negative Space

- Give the subject room to stand out
- Choose a simple area with low detail
- Use empty space for mood or copy
- Do not confuse empty with accidental

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Leading Lines

- Roads, rails, shadows and edges can guide the eye
- Enter the frame cleanly
- Aim toward the subject or story point
- Avoid lines that lead viewers out

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Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Frame Within a Frame

- Use doors, windows, branches or foreground shapes
- The inner frame concentrates attention
- Keep the frame relevant to the setting
- Do not cover important subject detail

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Patterns, Texture and Repetition

- Fill the frame to strengthen rhythm
- Break a pattern with one contrasting subject
- Side light reveals texture
- Repetition may be natural or arranged

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Contrast Creates Separation

- Tonal: light against dark
- Colour: warm against cool or complementary hues
- Scale: large against small
- Concept: old against new, still against moving

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Reflections and Visual Effects

- Use water, glass or polished metal
- Control angle to keep or remove reflections
- Symmetry can strengthen a mirrored scene
- Check for unwanted photographer reflections

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Scale and Depth

- Include a known-size reference
- Layer foreground, midground and background
- Overlap creates depth
- Perspective and focus can separate planes

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Rule of Space

- Leave room in front of a moving subject

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- Leave looking room in portraits
- Tight space can communicate pressure
- Match the space to the emotional intent

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Point of View

- Eye level feels neutral and relational
- High angle can reveal layout or reduce dominance
- Low angle can add presence
- Bird's-eye and worm's-eye views reshape context

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Arrange Subjects for Emotion

- Distance can imply connection or isolation
- Body direction creates relationships
- Eye lines connect people and objects
- Natural gestures read more credibly than rigid poses

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

The Blank-Canvas Check

- Scan every edge and corner
- Move yourself before moving the subject
- Simplify backgrounds and merge lines carefully
- Make every object earn its place

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Orientation, Crop and Aspect Ratio

- Portrait suits people and vertical channels
- Landscape suits environments and groups
- Square is graphic but removes side context
- Capture with the final use in mind

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Activity 5: Complete a Composition Photo Walk

Goal

A design studio needs a visual library of textures and urban details for a Singapore-themed mood board.

Deliverable

Ten-image contact sheet demonstrating ten named composition techniques

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Tools

Smartphone, grid overlay, optional macro attachment

Detailed Step-by-Step

1. Define a consistent theme, colour family and safe walking boundary.
2. Turn on the grid and capture one clear rule-of-thirds image.
3. Capture balance or symmetry with a level horizon and controlled edges.
4. Use negative space to isolate a small subject.
5. Use leading lines that end at a subject rather than leaving the frame.
6. Build a frame within a frame using architecture or foliage.
7. Capture pattern/texture and then break the pattern deliberately.
8. Use reflection without including an unwanted photographer image.
9. Create depth with foreground, midground and background layers.
10. Capture rule of space for a moving or looking subject, then curate and label all ten images.

Verification

- Ten distinct labelled techniques
- Primary subject is immediately identifiable
- Edges are clean and horizons intentional
- No privacy or location-rule breach

Troubleshooting

- If the control is missing, use the closest native mode and document the limitation.
- If the image is soft, clean the lens, stabilise the phone, re-focus and capture again.
- If highlights clip, reduce exposure or change the light/camera position.
- If safety or consent cannot be established, stop and substitute a controlled subject or location.

Activity folder: activities/activity-05-*/

Activity 6: Direct an Environmental Portrait and Property View

Goal

A small-business profile needs an owner portrait plus an interior image that describes the working environment.

Deliverable

Three portrait variations and two corrected interior views

Tools

Smartphone, window light, reflector/white card, tripod if available

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Detailed Step-by-Step

1. Ask consent and agree how the images will be used.
2. Choose soft window light and remove distracting or confidential background objects.
3. Place the owner off-centre with looking room toward the brighter area.
4. Guide a natural action instead of a rigid pose and focus on the near eye.
5. Capture eye-level, slightly high and contextual wide portrait variations.
6. For the interior, move to a corner that shows foreground, midground and background.
7. Keep the phone level so vertical lines remain straight.
8. Use HDR where highlight/shadow contrast is high and check for ghosting.
9. Capture one balanced/symmetrical view and one leading-line view.
10. Review facial edges, verticals, reflections, privacy and the story each image tells.

Verification

- Consent and use are recorded
- Portrait has credible skin tone and sharp eyes
- Interior verticals are controlled
- Five images communicate person and place

Troubleshooting

- If the control is missing, use the closest native mode and document the limitation.
- If the image is soft, clean the lens, stabilise the phone, re-focus and capture again.
- If highlights clip, reduce exposure or change the light/camera position.
- If safety or consent cannot be established, stop and substitute a controlled subject or location.

Activity folder: activities/activity-06-*/

Topic 04: Enhancing Visual Quality and Effects

Criteria: K6 · K7 · A6 · A7

Shot size · camera angle · creative capture · specialty cameras · editing · critique

Shot Sizes Build a Visual Story

- Extreme long establishes place
- Long/full shows the whole subject
- Medium shows action and relationship
- Close and extreme close reveal emotion or detail

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

A Five-Shot Coverage Pattern

- Establishing wide

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- Medium action
- Close-up detail
- Reaction or portrait
- Alternative angle for edit flexibility

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Camera Height and Angle

- Eye level feels balanced
- High angle reveals layout
- Low angle gives presence
- Bird's-eye and worm's-eye create graphic views

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Perspective as an Effect

- Get close for exaggerated foreground
- Step back for more natural proportions
- Tilt only when the instability is intentional
- Keep verticals straight for property and product work

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Portrait Mode and Depth Effects

- Separate subject from background
- Keep edges away from busy textures
- Use sufficient light
- Inspect hair, glasses, fingers and foreground errors

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Macro and Close-Up

- Stabilise the phone
- Find the minimum focus distance
- Focus on the most informative detail
- Use side light for texture

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Panorama

- Lock a stable stance and level horizon
- Sweep slowly around the phone
- Avoid subjects crossing the seam
- Review joins and bent lines before leaving

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Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Panning and Motion Blur

- Match the subject's direction
- Begin tracking before release
- Continue after capture
- Choose a background that shows motion

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Long Exposure and Light Painting

- Mount the phone
- Reduce ambient brightness or use an ND filter
- Trigger without touching
- Keep light movement controlled and safe

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Silhouette, Reflection and Flare

- Expose for the bright background to make a silhouette
- Change angle to control reflected detail
- Shade the lens when flare reduces contrast
- Use effects intentionally—not by accident

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Specialty Camera: Action Camera

- Small and mountable
- Protective housings support difficult environments
- Wide view captures context and movement
- Mounts must be load-rated and secure

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Specialty Camera: Lomography

- Simple optics may create vignette, blur or light leaks
- The result is an aesthetic choice
- Unpredictability can suit candid work
- Do not confuse an effect with technical failure

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Lens and Equipment Care

- Use a blower or microfibre cloth

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- Avoid touching optical surfaces
- Store dry in a protective case
- Check condensation, caps and mount wear

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

The Mobile Editing Pipeline

- Select the strongest frame
- Crop and straighten
- Balance exposure and tone
- Correct colour, refine detail and export

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Tone Before Colour

- Set overall exposure
- Recover highlights and open shadows
- Use contrast to shape—not crush—the image
- Check black and white points

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Colour and Detail with Restraint

- Correct white balance before creative grading
- Use saturation selectively
- Sharpen lightly at final size
- Avoid halos, waxy noise reduction and fake HDR

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Feedback That Improves the Next Shot

- Describe what is visible
- Connect it to the brief
- Identify one cause, not a vague dislike
- Recommend a specific camera position, setting or timing change

Decision cue: identify the subject, the light/technical variable, the intended viewer response and the evidence that proves the choice worked.

Activity 7: Select and Mount Specialty Camera Equipment

Goal

An outdoor education provider needs a safe action sequence and asks whether a phone, action camera or creative toy-camera look is appropriate.

Deliverable

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Equipment decision, mounting inspection, five-shot action sequence and feedback note

Tools

Smartphone, action camera/housing or simulator, rated mount, safety tether

Detailed Step-by-Step

1. Read the action brief, environment limits and required shot sizes.
2. Compare phone, action camera and lomography-style options against the brief.
3. Select equipment based on field of view, durability, control and intended aesthetic.
4. Inspect housing seals, mount threads, clamp, tether and battery condition.
5. Choose a mounting point that does not obstruct movement, controls or protective gear.
6. Run a stationary test and apply a secondary safety tether.
7. Capture establishing, full, medium, close detail and alternative-angle shots.
8. Stop operation immediately if the mount loosens or the route becomes unsafe.
9. Review horizon, wide-angle distortion, vibration and subject visibility.
10. Write feedback recommending one change to angle, mount or movement for the next run.

Verification

- Equipment choice is justified
- Mount and tether pass inspection
- Five-shot sequence covers the action
- Feedback links an observable defect to a specific correction

Troubleshooting

- If the control is missing, use the closest native mode and document the limitation.
- If the image is soft, clean the lens, stabilise the phone, re-focus and capture again.
- If highlights clip, reduce exposure or change the light/camera position.
- If safety or consent cannot be established, stop and substitute a controlled subject or location.

Activity folder: activities/activity-07-*/

Activity 8: Edit and Deliver a Tourism Campaign Set

Goal

A local travel business needs six consistent photographs for a web page, square social post and vertical story.

Deliverable

Six-image final set, before/after comparisons, export matrix and critique record

Tools

Built-in editor, Lightroom Mobile or Snapseed; file manager/cloud folder

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Detailed Step-by-Step

1. Select six frames that cover place, people/action and detail without duplication.
2. Duplicate originals or work non-destructively before editing.
3. Straighten and crop for the intended aspect ratio while protecting key content.
4. Correct exposure, highlights, shadows and contrast before changing colour.
5. Correct white balance and apply one restrained, consistent colour treatment.
6. Apply selective healing only to temporary distractions—not documentary facts.
7. Add light sharpening at final size and avoid halos or excessive noise reduction.
8. Export landscape, square and vertical versions using the export matrix.
9. Compare before/after images for realism, consistency, artefacts and privacy.
10. Run a peer critique and record one angle/capture improvement for a future reshoot.

Verification

- Six images are visually consistent
- Edits retain natural texture and colour
- Exports match the named channels
- Critique contains a specific evidence-based improvement

Troubleshooting

- If the control is missing, use the closest native mode and document the limitation.
- If the image is soft, clean the lens, stabilise the phone, re-focus and capture again.
- If highlights clip, reduce exposure or change the light/camera position.
- If safety or consent cannot be established, stop and substitute a controlled subject or location.

Activity folder: activities/activity-08-*/

Quick Reference

Situation	First action	Then check
Soft image	Clean lens and tap the subject	Stability, shutter time and focus distance
Bright sky/dark subject	Tap subject and adjust exposure or use HDR	Ghosting and highlight detail
Yellow/blue colour	Set an appropriate white-balance preset	Skin tone and consistency across frames
Moving subject	Use burst/fast capture or pan deliberately	Timing, blur direction and safe position
Low light	Stabilise and use night/manual mode	Noise, clipped lamps and subject movement
Weak composition	Simplify edges and choose one subject	Placement, lines, space, depth and contrast
Over-edited image	Reduce saturation, clarity and sharpening	Natural texture and honest colour

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Assessment Flow

1. Complete TRAQOM/SSG digital attendance.
2. Complete Assessment digital attendance.
3. Sit the Written Assessment, then Practical Performance; both are open book.
4. Submit completed answers on the LMS.
5. Review the outcome and sign the Assessment Summary Record.

Open LMS/TMS

Sources

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Support

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